

example, has bulbs that last for years. I doubt they even knew what happened to the “space age” tech that was supposed to trickle down to them. With Apple’s help, we brought down battery lives to barely a year. The Westley vs Apple case was a minor hitch in our plans, but we’ve managed to overcome even that now.

Our conditioning was working. Customers were accepting mediocrity. The scraps we fed the cattle were enough, they thought they were getting the very best and were happy. They didn’t aspire for more. Now we could focus on the more important aspects, getting these cattle to fight amongst themselves, fighting for our favour. Those poor creatures couldn’t look beyond the glistening trinkets we were throwing at them, each trinket a little bit larger, a little bit shinier, maybe a different colour. We told them that red was the new black and they wanted it. We always showed them what was coming next of course, something a little bit nicer and once in a while, slipped that very thing into the hands of a select few. They wanted it, they fought for it; they sold their very organs to own those products.

We have to work hard to please those creatures; they’re finicky to a fault. They don’t want any responsibilities; they just want to be happy, lost in the moment with not a care in the world. And it isn’t just that, if they get that responsibility they might rise to that challenge, realise that they have a purpose in life. This cannot, *must not*, happen! We gave them the satisfaction of believing they were safe and happy, we even took the trouble to collect their waste and shipped it off to Africa as manure. Out of sight, out of mind, and it worked. They were content. We had a system that worked, how did

we f\*\*\* it up? By letting our greed get the better of us, that’s how. We started bickering amongst ourselves, fighting for the favor of those very same cattle that used to eat out of our hands. We lost our power, handed it back to the consumers. In our bid to outdo each other, we pampered the consumer too much. We didn’t just dangle the carrot, we gave it to them, as many as we could afford. They were not ready for it and with the attention span that they currently have, it

# Obsolete



wasn’t long before they got bored and wanted more. Like a child king whom everyone is trying to please. The little king was generous, he threw away his money on us but he also got bored very fast. We gave him everything before he was ready for it and when we were done, he wanted more. How could we provide them with that? We stretched ourselves to the limit and for what, a marginal increase in profits?

This has to stop. Those cattle aren’t completely dumb, just too distracted to care and when the distractions stopped, they started wandering off looking for something else. Some of them got wind of what we were up to and started a resistance movement. They’re getting wise to our methods now and we have to stop them. Oh there were always the few who were never smitten by our methods. The “intelligent” ones, like that Russian chap who figured out that we were putting kill chips in our printers ([www.ssclg.com](http://www.ssclg.com)). Those were easy to deal with, label them conspiracy theorists, obfuscate our methods, but in the end, people will just believe what they want to believe so we didn’t really have to work that hard. But

## PHOEBUS CARTEL

This was a consortium of a group of manufacturers, including Philips and General Electric amongst others. Established in the 1920s, who decided that long-lasting bulbs were a detriment to the economy.

They very deliberately set about shortening the lifespan of all bulbs in the western world, finally managing to bring down product life from 2500 hours to below 1000 hours in the span of 20 years. They actively discouraged long-lasting bulbs and the cartel even bought out competitors just to maintain a stranglehold on bulb manufacture. A side-effect of this was that all bulbs were standardised by the 1940s.



The 100 year old lightbulb that has outlived three of those cameras



- DIGI POWER DESIGN
- DUAL-STACK MOSFET
- PREMIUM ALLOY CHOKE
- MULTIPLE FILTER CAP
- TWIN-POWER COOLING HEATSINK
- 8 LAYER PCB, 4 X 2oz COPPER



Designed by World Overclocking Champion, NickShih



NickShih

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